

New Generation English B· Diagnostic Test

B1 (Intermediate Strong) B· Reading

READING

The slow return of letter writing

For about fifteen years almost no one wrote letters by hand. Email had taken over, then messengers, then voice notes. Even birthday cards were quietly disappearing. Yet in the last three or four years a small but visible group of people “most of them under thirty” have started writing letters again.

What surprised researchers was not the trend itself but who was driving it. The new letter-writers were not nostalgic older people; they were the same generation that grew up with smartphones. In interviews they often describe the same shift: a tiredness with the speed of digital messages, a wish for something slower, and a desire to send something that the receiver cannot delete with one tap.

There is also a quieter cultural reason. Several writers, including some Russian and British essayists, have argued that a hand-written letter forces a kind of attention that has become rare. You cannot easily multitask while writing one. You cannot change it after sending. The slowness is the point.

This does not mean that letters will replace messengers, of course. They will not. But the recent revival shows something interesting about digital fatigue: when a technology saturates everyday life, even small analogue alternatives start to feel meaningful again. Letter writing has become, for some people, a small ritual of paying attention “to one person, for one moment.

1. For about how many years did almost no one write letters by hand?

A) Five.

B) Fifteen.

C) Fifty.

2. Who are the new letter-writers mostly?

A) People over seventy.

B) People under thirty.

C) Schoolchildren.

3. What surprised researchers?

A) The growth of email.

B) Who was driving the revival.

C) The collapse of postal services.

4. What is one common feeling the new letter-writers describe?

A) Boredom with paper.

B) A tiredness with the speed of digital messages.

C) A love of high-tech writing apps.

5. What can the receiver NOT do with a letter?

A) Delete it with one tap.

B) Read it twice.

C) Show it to a friend.

6. What kind of attention does the letter force, according to several writers?

A) Distracted attention.

B) A kind of attention that has become rare.

C) Mechanical attention.

7. Will letters replace messengers, according to the text?

A) Yes, completely.

B) No, they will not.

C) Only in business.

8. What has letter writing become for some people?

A) A new commercial product.

B) A small ritual of paying attention.

C) An old-fashioned mistake.